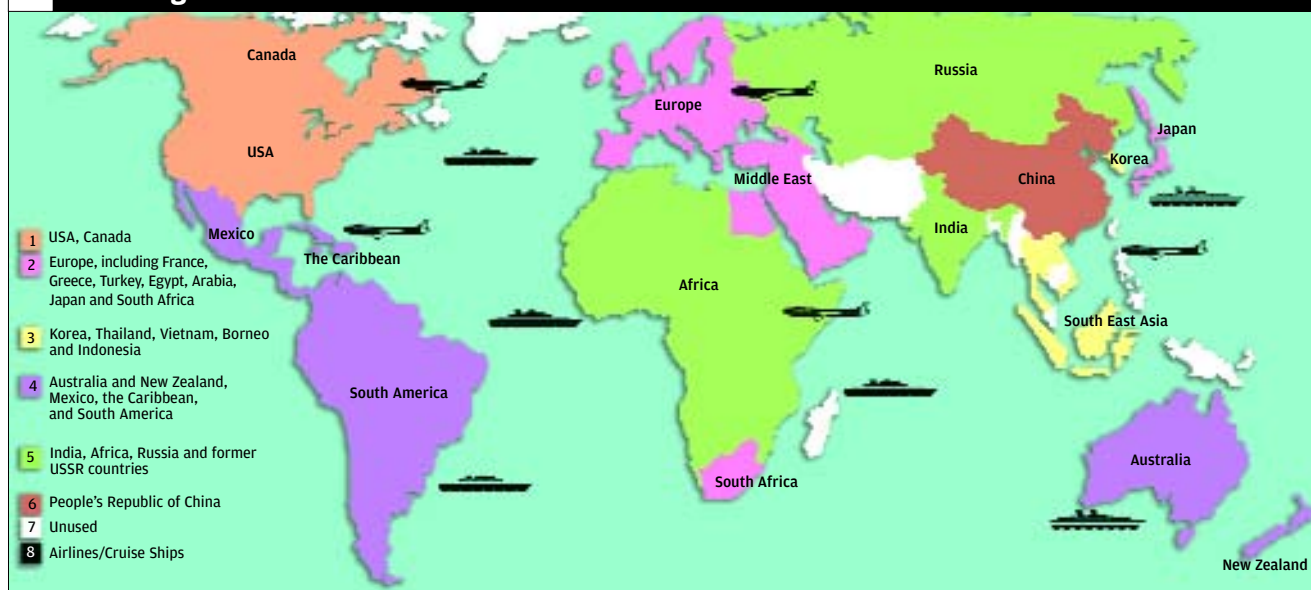


DVD Regions



DVD-R (A) disks offer 3.95 GB of space, while DVD-R (G) disks provide 4.7 GB.

DVD-RAM

It's a fast-disappearing DVD format, ushered in just after the DVD-R made its appearance. These disks are still preferred by those who munch video for a living. The reason was that it was the only format that allowed direct data manipulation on the disk in real-time, without having to rewrite the whole disk. Initially, these disks came with a storage capacity of 2.8 GB, which later increased to 4.7 GB.

The DVD+R and DVD+RW formats

The DVD+R and DVD+RW alliance was formed by Dell, Hewlett-Packard Company, MCC/Verbatim, Philips Electronics, Ricoh Company Ltd, Sony Corporation, Thomson Multimedia and Yamaha Corporation. These companies formed their own consortium and came up with these two formats.

They are relatively new. Worldwide, they were made available only in late 2001. The DVD+R made its appearance only in mid-2002.

Advantages and Disadvantages

Unlike other formats, DVD-RAM media are disks housed in cartridges, which DVD-ROM drives cannot read. A later version allowed the disk to be removed from the cartridge, but DVD-ROM drives still failed to read them.

DVD-Rs and DVD-RWs are incompatible with DVD+R and DVD+RW media. You cannot write to either of these disks using interchangeable writer drives. Hence, drive manufacturers came up with dual-format DVD drives that can actually write to all of them.

DVD-R media are written at a lower speed than that used for DVD+R media. Both have a theoretical limit of 16X, and a few DVD-writer drives write at 12X. The DVD-R format is yet to do so. The higher the media speed, the faster your job gets done, provided the drive writes at that speed. Another aspect is the finalisation

property. Say, you want to write a video-DVD comprising different clips. In the case of a DVD-RW, you need to finalise the DVD. It means, simply mark the lead-in and lead-out before you play it on a standalone DVD player. A DVD+RW though can play on a DVD player without finalisation. This feature is known as the DVD+RW VR (Video Recording). Hence, you

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